# September CPI: preview and analysis

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By Neha Sharma & Justin Smirk

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September quarter unrevised but December upgraded significantly.



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- September CPI to rise 0.62%mth with the annual pace lifting to 4.1%yr from 4.0%yr. The seasonally adjusted CPI lifts 0.5%mth, a step down from the 0.7% increase in August.
- September Trimmed Mean (TM) is set to lift 0.26%mth holding the annual pace steady at 3.6%yr.

- As we noted in our review of the August CPI, our September quarter CPI estimate is unchanged at 1.3%qtr while the TM remained 0.9%qtr.
- Auto fuel surged ahead of our expectations so along with signs of increase pass-through we lifted our December quarter CPI to 1.3%qtr/3.9%yr and the TM estimate to 0.9%qtr/3.5%yr.
- This is a 0.8ppt increase to the CPI estimate, and a 0.2ppt increase to the TM estimate, highlighting inflation momentum meaningfully above the RBA's current expectations.
- However, these factors can shift quickly and we see downside risk to our 2027 inflation profile should energy prices ease faster than expected.

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